

Water Bottle — TryHackMe CTF Writeup

Platform: TryHackMe | Category: OSINT | Difficulty: Easy – Medium | Room: waterbottle

1. Challenge Description

The scenario: after returning to my hometown, I needed a water refill from a station I frequently used **until 2014**, but I have forgotten its name and contact number. I only remember that the contact number is **twelve digits** and **starts with 63922**. While driving near **Boni Avenue**, a new water refilling establishment now stands where the original station used to be. The task is to find the **name** and **contact number** of the original water station.

Flag format: THM{station_name_in_lowercase_contact_number}

2. Analysing the Clues

The number prefix tells us a lot before we even search:

- **63922** = Philippines country code **63** + Globe Telecom mobile prefix **922** — so the full number is 63-922-XXX-XXXX.
- Location: **Boni Avenue, Mandaluyong City, Metro Manila** — the station was active until around **2014** and has since been replaced.
- The masked answer format (star count) hints: the name appears to be **8 characters** and the number **12 digits**.

3. Step-by-Step Investigation

Step 1 — Anchor points on Google Maps

The room provides two Google Maps short links that pin down the exact location:

Link	What it shows
maps.app.goo.gl/4H17ZWf5nccRRr2s8	Street View from April 2014 @ 14.57887, 121.0318302 — pin now reads “Water Refilling Station”
maps.app.goo.gl/SiALJgGf29jjGJt69	Water JAM Water Refilling Station @ 14.578967, 121.032311 — the NEW station

Both coordinates are roughly 15 metres apart — essentially the same spot. **Water JAM** is the new establishment that replaced the original station.

Step 2 — Recovering the 2014 imagery

Decoding the first Maps link redirect gives the Street View **panoid** and capture date:

```
panoid = NHB-mXd1toBgIIV0ouSCkQ
date   = 20140401 (April 2014)
```

Using the Street View Pixels API to pull thumbnails from that panorama at different yaw angles (east, south-west) reveals a **yellow and blue structure** across the Boni Avenue median — matching **Blue Cube Water Re-Filling Station** at 425 Pulo cor. Boni Ave, Barangay Malamig (active circa 2012, per its Foursquare listing).

Step 3 — Searching business directories

The 2014 era also left footprints in older directories (Waze, Cybo, Foursquare, contact.page, Scribd barangay lists). The candidates found:

Station	Address	Contact	Matches?
Water Market Refilling Station	19 Domingo M. Guevara, Mandaluyong	092 874 6887 → 639228746887	12 digits, 63922 ✓ — but name has 12 chars
Blue Cube Water Re-Filling	425 Pulong cor. Boni Ave, Malamig	(02) 497 2712 (landline)	8-char name ✓ — but no 63922 mobile
Aquabest — Mandaluyong, Boni	31 Mayon St, Boni, Mandaluyong	+63 922 872 1228 → 639228721228	12 digits ✓ · 63922 ✓ · 8 chars ✓
Grandeur Water Station	705 Boni Ave, Malamig	(02) 533 4069 (landline)	No matching mobile number

Step 4 — Confirming the match: Aquabest

The **Aquabest** Boni branch contact page (contact.page) lists:

- Address: Unit D, Villa Maria Apartment, 31 Mayon Street, Boni, Mandaluyong City
- Mobile: **+63 922 872 1228** → 63-922-872-1228 = **12 digits starting with 63922** ✓
- Name aquabest = **8 characters** ✓

Aquabest is a long-running Philippine franchise (active well before 2014), and its Boni branch was later replaced by **Water JAM** at the same location — matching the challenge story perfectly.

4. The Flag

```
THM{aquabest_639228721228}
```

5. Tools Used

Google Maps (short-link decoding + historical Street View) · Google Street View Pixels API · Waze live map · Foursquare venue listings · contact.page · Scribd (Kalokál Barangay Highway Hills directory) · Cybo · PuertoParrot

6. What Didn't Work & Lessons Learned

- **Water Market Refilling Station** — phone format was perfect (639228746887) but the name is 12 characters, which does not fit the 8-character answer slot.
- **Blue Cube Water Re-Filling Station** — correct name length and visible in the 2014 Street View, but only ever had a landline, no 63922 mobile number.
- Count the stars in the masked answer format — TryHackMe often leaks the answer's length.
- Directory sites like contact.page keep numbers complete in international format even when partially masked — always verify the full number.
- Old Street View panoramas can be re-fetched by panoid/date via Google's thumbnail API.
- A franchise brand may be gone from a location while the chain still exists — don't assume “still listed” means “still there.”

Writeup generated for personal study purposes. Solve the room yourself before reading this — OSINT rooms are the most fun when you don't peek.